

TOPIC 5: HUMAN TRAFFICKING – MEANING AND HEALTH IMPLICATIONS

1. Meaning of Human Trafficking

Human trafficking is the recruitment, transportation, transfer, harbouring or receipt of persons by means of threat, force, coercion, abduction, fraud or deception for the purpose of exploitation. Exploitation may include forced labour, sexual exploitation, forced begging or organ removal. It is a serious crime and a violation of human rights.

2. Forms of Trafficking

- Trafficking for sexual exploitation
- Trafficking for forced labour or domestic servitude
- Child trafficking for begging, street trading or other exploitation
- Trafficking for organ removal (less common but serious)

3. Health Implications on Victims

- Physical injuries, exhaustion and malnutrition
- Sexually transmitted infections and unwanted pregnancies
- Mental health problems: depression, anxiety, post-traumatic stress, loss of self-esteem
- Long-term disability or chronic illness from abuse and neglect
- Social isolation and difficulty reintegrating into family and community

4. Why Young People Are Vulnerable

Poverty, lack of education, family breakdown, false job or education offers, and weak protection systems increase risk. Awareness helps students protect themselves and others.

5. Summary

Human trafficking is exploitation through force or deception. It causes serious physical and mental health harm. Knowing the signs and risks is the first step in prevention.

End of Topic 5